



SCHOOL CHOICE PROCEDURE (OPEN ENROLLMENT)

~~The Board of Education supports a variety of high quality educational programs. Students may attend their district designated neighborhood school (based on home address), or application may be made for open enrollment to another neighborhood school, a focus school (meets BVSD standards but may have a different curriculum or philosophy), or a charter school (an independent school within the district) in our school district.~~

~~GENERAL INFORMATION~~

- ~~1. Before completing the open enrollment process, parents/guardians should obtain information about the school to which they are applying so that they are informed about the program. Opportunities to visit and observe schools may be scheduled by contacting individual school offices.~~
- ~~2. Approval of open enrollment is based on available space, programming, and staffing at the requested school. Some schools/grade levels may have no spaces to offer. When the number of applicants exceeds the number of spaces available, students will be selected by a random selection lottery.~~
- ~~3. When a student has been enrolled in any school under the open enrollment policy, that school becomes the "school of attendance" through the highest grade offered at the school. To return to the district neighborhood school, an Open Enrollment application must be submitted during the Open Enrollment period for the following year. Approval will be granted if there is space available.~~
- ~~4. After open enrolling to an elementary, middle or K-8 school, and completing the highest grade in that school, students will attend their district designated neighborhood school unless they open enroll to another middle or high school. Students do not receive preference or assurance in applying for Open Enrollment to the next level school in the feeder system.~~
- ~~5. Students who enroll in a school other than their district designated neighborhood school are responsible for their own transportation. If space is available on an~~

~~existing transportation route, parents/guardians may petition for “ridership” by contacting the district’s ¶~~

~~Transportation Office at (720) 561-5120. This petition process occurs after the school year begins. Parents/Guardians must petition every year for space available ridership. ¶~~

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- ~~6. Misrepresentation of information will be grounds to invalidate an Open Enrollment application.~~

~~OPEN ENROLLMENT PROCESS AND TIMELINES~~ **Process and Timelines**

The School District will notify resident students and their parents/guardians on an annual basis of the school choice options available through open enrollment in sufficient time to apply. Notice will identify specific steps to apply for choice enrollment and timelines that are enforceable, including:

- an application deadline no earlier than January 1
- a deadline of not more than ten (10) days for the parent/guardian to accept and complete enrollment for awarded choice seats or the seat will be forfeited
- an opportunity for any student who missed the application deadline to submit an application prior to the last business day of August to add the student’s name to the bottom of an established wait list. New residents of the School District filing an initial application shall be added at the top of late applications ~~to added to~~ an established wait list.
- the ability of students to enroll to choice seats from wait lists to fill vacant spots-as available following the lottery through August, for some charter schools until September 3, and for other charter schools on a space available basis year round

~~To help families make decisions, the School District will make school choice and enrollment data, including length of waitlists, as accessible as possible. ¶~~

~~Students with Disabilities~~ ¶

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~~Students with an active Individual Education Plan (IEP) have the same opportunity to open enroll as their typical peers. The open enrollment application does not request information about disability status and admits all students through the lottery. Once a student has been admitted and completes the online enrollment process, the School District will convene as necessary an IEP team to determine whether the selected school can deliver a free appropriate public education (FAPE). If the IEP team determines that FAPE is not available in the school of choice, the School District will issue a prior written notice in accordance with federal and state law. ¶~~

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~~Athletic and Activities Eligibility~~

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~~Students assigned to schools through choice will have the same curricular and extracurricular status as all other students attending the school, as determined by applicable law, bylaws of the Colorado High School Activities Association, and the School District's eligibility requirements.~~

~~Preschool~~

~~Due to complexities in Colorado law, preschool assignments in BVSD shall not be subject to open enrollment procedures.~~

~~Unless the parent/guardian promptly accepts the offer and completes online enrollment (if necessary), the student forfeits the seat awarded through the Open Enrollment process.~~

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~~1. Parents/guardians must complete the application process no later than 4:00 p.m. on the day of the deadline stated on the School District website in order to be included in the lottery selection process. Misrepresentation of information will be grounds to invalidate an Open Enrollment application.~~

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~~2. Parents/guardians must apply online. Parents who do not have online access are encouraged to use eComputers are available for this purpose at many schools, and in the Open Enrollment office, during the window for open enrollment that will be advertised on the district's website. Only one application per child may be submitted (multiple applications will be deleted).~~

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~~3. The lottery process runs in two sequential stages and incorporates preferences established in Board Policy and charter school contracts following the preferences established in this regulation:~~

- ~~a. The first lottery will includes students who live inside School District boundaries and students who live outside of the School District if they have a sibling attending a BVSD school (as described in preference 2 below) or a parent employed by the School District (as described in preference 3 below).~~
- ~~b. The second lottery will includes out of district students to fill any seats available after the first lottery.~~

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~~9.4. Notification of acceptance or waitlist status will be sent to the original pool of timely applicants in the week following lottery completion.~~

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~~10.5. If a notification of acceptance is extended, parents/guardians who wish to accept the seat have 10 calendar days from the emailed notice of acceptance to:~~

~~e.a. Indicate their acceptance in the open enrollment online system ¶~~

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~~AND, for new students or those returning after a break in enrollment, ¶~~

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~~a.b. Complete the online enrollment process and provide any supporting documents to the accepted school. Currently enrolled BVSD students will have their information updated automatically. ¶~~

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~~**Unless the parent/guardian promptly accepts the offer and completes online enrollment (if necessary), the student forfeits the seat awarded through the Open Enrollment process. ¶**~~

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~~41.6. Parents/guardians who do not receive notification of lottery results, have 10 calendar days to contact the Open Enrollment office. ¶~~

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~~42.7. Once a student has been accepted to the first choice, whether the seat is declined or not, the student will not be considered for lower choices in the open enrollment process and will receive no further notifications. ¶~~

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~~43.8. Wait lists will be established from the applications received during the open enrollment period. Students from the wait list will be emailed or called to fill verified vacant spots, as available beginning in February through August.~~

~~Misrepresentation of information will be grounds to invalidate an Open Enrollment application.~~

~~———— Note: The Open Enrollment cycle for Peak to Peak, Summit and Horizons is active ———— through the last day of September. ¶~~

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~~**INFORMATION REGARDING SPECIAL PROGRAMS ¶**~~

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~~**Students with Disabilities:** Students with an active Individual Education Plan (IEP) have the same opportunity to open enroll as their typical peers. The open enrollment application does not request information about disability status and admits all students through the lottery. Once a student has been admitted and completes the online enrollment process, the School District will convene as necessary an IEP team to determine whether the selected school can deliver a free appropriate public education (FAPE). ¶~~

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~~Contact the Special Education department at (720) 561-5155 with questions. ¶~~

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~~**ELD:** Models for delivering English Language Development services vary by school. Please contact the English Language Development department at (720) 561-5073 for more information. ¶~~

Athletic and Activities Eligibility: Per the Colorado High School Athletics Association guidelines, a student entering high school for the first time shall be eligible for all interscholastic athletic competition. Students transferring schools after entering high school without a qualifying move may jeopardize eligibility.

PRESCHOOL

Due to Colorado law, preschool in all BVSD schools will look different in 2023-2024. More information will be available in January 2023.

District and School Annual Enrollment PREFERENCES

For annual school assignment, students within designated attendance areas, including those desiring to take classes on a part-time basis in accordance with Board Policy and those who previously enrolled through school choice outside of their neighborhood school, will have priority in registering in that neighborhood school. Students may apply for open enrollment in a school outside their attendance area and will be admitted through an enrollment lottery incorporating the preferences detailed below if there is space available in the requested school and program. If fewer spaces are available than applications submitted, BVSD will conduct a lottery process in two sequential stages:

2. The first lottery will include students who live inside School District boundaries and students who live outside of the School District if they fit within one of the top five preferences below.

The second lottery will include out-of-district students to fill any seats available after the first lottery.

School District Preferences:

The open enrollment lottery process. In the event a lottery is necessary for open enrollment applications for any given school year, the lottery shall incorporate preferences as follows:

These preferences apply to open enrollment applications except as otherwise noted below.

1. In-district students who move out of their School District designated neighborhood school attendance area but who remain in the School District and wish to remain at the school the student is currently attending.
2. Sibling/Household preferences:

- a. A new student, whether they reside inside or outside of the district, whose sibling/**household member** has been in attendance and will be attending the requested school the following year.
- b. A sibling/**household member** of a student accepting placement during the same open enrollment period.

Note: When multiple siblings/**household members** apply for open enrollment at the same school and in choice order, they will be linked as siblings/**household members** in the lottery process.

3. A student of an eligible employee, whether they reside inside or outside of the district. Eligible employees **must be working for BVSD at the time of the application and on the first day of the applicable school year.** ~~are those who are at the benefit level for each of their respective employee groups, i.e. 20 hours per week or more for classified and .50 FTE for licensed and professional/technical employees.~~
NOTE: If there is an enrollment opening at the time of employment, an employee's children may be enrolled immediately. If there is no space available, the employee's enrollment preference will be applied -will wait until in the following school year or the next available space.
4. BVSD students wishing to return to their designated neighborhood school.
5. Students who reside within the boundaries of BVSD.
6. Current students who move outside the boundaries of BVSD and wish to remain **for a future school year in-**at the school the student is currently attending.
7. Students who reside outside the boundaries of BVSD.

School Preferences

~~In addition to the criteria listed above, some schools have additional preferences.~~

Focus Schools (Boulder Community School of Integrated Studies (BCSIS), and High Peaks: Community Montessori, High Peaks):

1. Sibling preferences as per the District's selection process.

2.1. Include a Family Income preference for This preference applies to in-district applicants who submit an optional current year economic survey as part of their open enrollment application and qualify as low income. Scholarships and transportation are

provided for 20% of the qualifying Kindergarten aged children who attend full day Kindergarten.

3.2. After these preferences are met, the regular selection process will apply.

Boulder Community School of Integrated Studies (BCSIS) and High Peaks:

1. Sibling preferences as per the regular selection process.

2.1. Family Income

This preference applies to in-district applicants who submit an optional current year economic survey as part of their online open enrollment application and, qualify as low-income, and reside within a 1 ½ mile walking distance of the Aurora 7 school site (refer to map [BCSIS/High Peaks](#)) until 20% of the qualifying entering Kindergarten aged children are enrolled.

3.2. Geographic Area

If 20% of the seats reserved for low-income students are not filled, then students eligible for low-income status who reside south of Colorado and west of Cherryvale Rd and east of 4th Ave. (refer to map [BCSIS/High Peaks](#)) until 20% of the low-income qualifying entering Kindergarten aged students are enrolled.

4.3. After these preferences are met, the regular selection process will apply.

Lafayette, Escuela Bilingüe Pioneer, Ryan, and Sanchez: When applying to Escuela Bilingüe Pioneer or University Hill Dual Language, native English speaking students in grades 1st through 5th should have an educational background in a bilingual program and will be assessed by the school to determine program appropriateness prior to final acceptance.

Note: Escuela Bilingüe Pioneer is a Focus School and follows focus school procedures with the addition of the geographic preference below.

Focus Schools (Lafayette, Ryan, and Sanchez)

Follow a Neighborhood Focus Schools follow the neighborhood preference before a geographic preference that

1. Sibling preferences as per the regular selection process.

2.1. Geographic Area

This preference applies to applicants who reside inside the boundaries of any of the Lafayette/Erie schools of BVSD; i.e. the attendance boundaries of each school in Lafayette.

~~3.2. After these preferences are met, the regular selection process will apply.~~

~~When applying to Escuela Bilingüe Pioneer or University Hill Dual Language, native English speaking students in grades 1st through 5th should have an educational background in a bilingual program and will be assessed by the school to determine program appropriateness prior to final acceptance.~~

Charter School Preferences

~~BVSD intends for charter school admission criteria to be incorporated into charter contracts and not revised annually. BVSD is committed to equitable criteria for open enrollment and the elimination of special and legacy preferences for school founders and alumni, and for those who have applied for admission previously. BVSD intends for charter school admission criteria to be incorporated into charter contracts and not revised annually.~~ The schools below will have their criteria reviewed in the next charter school negotiation if they do not elect to adopt the School District's preferences earlier.

~~Note: The Open Enrollment cycle for Peak to Peak, Summit and Horizons is active through the last day of September.~~

Horizons K-8 Charter:

1. Children of Faculty (licensed, non-temporary employee) employed in a licensed Faculty position of 0.25 F.T.E. or greater, whether they reside inside or outside the BVSD boundaries.
2. Sibling of a student who is attending and will be attending Horizons the following year. **-EQUAL preference with –**
Children of Faculty employed in a licensed temporary full-time, temporary part-time or temporary job-share Faculty position, with a one year contract of 0.25 F.T.E or greater (whether they reside inside or outside the BVSD boundaries).
3. Sibling of a student who is assigned in the current year.
4. Children of non-licensed staff in their 2nd consecutive year, or subsequent, of employment at 25% or greater (i.e., 10+ hours/week), whether they reside inside or outside the BVSD boundaries.
5. Family Income Preference: In-district applicants who submit an optional current year Family Economic Data Survey as part of their online open enrollment

application and qualify as low income, until 25% of the total open enrollment slots are filled with low-income students.

~~5.6. Other community preferences as already stated in BVSD Policy JECC R. ¶~~

NOTE: If there is an enrollment opening at the time of employment, a licensed employee's children may be enrolled immediately. If there is no space available, the employee's enrollment preference will be applied ~~will wait until in~~ the following school year or the next available space.

Preferences for Peak to Peak Charter:

(Preferences #1 through #5 are applicable whether a student resides inside or outside the boundaries of BVSD.)

1. Children of teachers, administrators and counselors who are employed by Peak to Peak. This preference excludes children of person(s) holding solely a substitute position at Peak to Peak.
 2. Children of staff other than teachers, administrators, and counselors, who are employed at Peak to Peak for a minimum of 10 hours per week. This preference excludes children of person(s) holding solely a substitute position at Peak to Peak. Staff exercising this preference must remain in their positions through the end of the school year in which the Open Enrollment application is completed.
 3. Siblings of students attending Peak to Peak during the Open Enrollment application period and will be attending Peak to Peak the next school year.
 4. Siblings of students who are currently seniors during the open enrollment period.
 5. Siblings of students who have been selected for admission into Peak to Peak.
 6. Family income: This preference applies to in-district applicants who submit an optional Family Economic Data Survey as part of their online open enrollment application and qualify as low-income, until 20% of the qualifying entering K-12th grade students are enrolled.
- ~~6.7.~~ A resident student, who applies during the open-enrollment period, is placed on the waiting list, is not offered admission before the next lottery period, and re-applies for admission in the immediately successive open enrollment period.
- ~~7.8.~~ Alumni children: Children of resident parents/guardians who graduated from Peak to Peak.

~~8:9.~~ Students who live within the BVSD boundaries

~~9:10.~~ Students who live outside of BVSD boundaries who have previously applied to Peak to Peak, are placed on the waiting list. ~~is-are~~ not offered admission before the next lottery period, and re-applyies for admission in the immediately successive open enrollment period.

~~10:11.~~ Students who live outside the BVSD boundaries.

Preferences for Summit Charter:

1. Children of school organizers and of present and former Directors.
2. Children of Summit current teachers and staff residing in or out of District.
3. In District siblings of currently enrolled students and Summit graduates (completed 8th grade at Summit), including those accepted in the current lottery.
4. Family Income – This preference applies to in-district applicants for 6th grade who submit an optional current year economic survey as part of their online open enrollment application and qualify as low-income, until 10% of the qualifying entering 6th grade students are enrolled.
5. In District with prior application (a student who was placed on the waitlist and declined an opportunity to enroll at Summit is not eligible for this priority).
6. Students who reside within the boundaries of BVSD.
7. Out of District sibling of current Summit student or a former Summit graduate.
8. Out of district students.

End File: JECC-R